



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Communication Skills

PRINCIPLES OF MARKETING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- “The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation.”
- “You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge).”
- “You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event.”
- “Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event.”

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of effective verbal communications.
2. Analyze the impact of technology on marketing.
3. Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.
4. Reinforce service orientation through communication.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a marketing associate at THE BEAN SCENE, a popular local coffee shop chain. The owner of the company (judge) has asked you to determine the best way to communicate a major change in the customer loyalty program to both customers and staff.

For the past 10 years, THE BEAN SCENE has used paper punch cards where customers receive one free drink after purchasing ten. However, due to rising printing costs and a lack of customer data, the owner (judge) has decided to discontinue the paper cards and launch a mobile app. The new app will allow customers to earn points on every dollar spent and receive personalized birthday coupons.

The owner (judge) is worried about the transition. Many loyal customers are older and may be resistant to downloading an app or sharing their email addresses. Additionally, the owner (judge) has seen negative reviews on social media regarding other local businesses that switched to digital-only platforms, where customers complained about privacy and "technological complications."

The owner (judge) wants you to determine how to effectively communicate this transition to ensure customer retention. You must outline a plan that includes:

- How to verbally explain the change to frustrated customers at the register.
- A written informational message (social media post or in-store sign) announcing the change.
- How to address customer concerns regarding data privacy and the new technology.

You will present your ideas to the owner (judge) in a role-play to take place in the owner's (judge's) office. The owner (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work,.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How should our baristas respond if a customer refuses to download the app but demands a stamp on their old card?
2. Why is it important that we use social media to announce this, rather than just telling people in the store?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of effective verbal communications.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Analyze the impact of technology on marketing.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Reinforce service orientation through communication.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
5.	Unique Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	Practical Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Effective Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
8.	Critical Thinking Think critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	Communication Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Decision Making Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
11.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
TOTAL SCORE						